Despite this, the Government of India's total expenditure (Rs 22.8 lakh crore) in nine months was 74.9 per cent of BE–21 (Rs 30.4 lakh crore). This was marginally less than the expenditure of 75.7 per cent incurred in first nine months of the year 2019–20. Both revenue expenditure and capital expenditure were quite close to the expenditure levels of the previous year.

There was, however, a distortion in capital expenditure. The government had disbursed Rs 0.84 lakh crore as loans against disbursement of only Rs 0.21 lakh crore last year. These loans, given to the Railways and the states, were exceptional and meant to cover revenue expenditures, and therefore not the Centre's real capital expenditure. Excluding these loans, the Centre's capital expenditure was only Rs 2.25 lakh crore (54.5 per cent) in the first nine months, which was lower than the Rs 2.34 lakh crore incurred the previous year.

Expenditures in Revised Estimates 2020–21 Jumped to Rs 34.50 Lakh Crore

Revised estimates placed as part of Budget 2021–22 heralded a big jump in expenditures. Total budgeted expenditure went up from Rs 30.42 lakh crore in budget estimates to Rs 34.50 lakh crore in revised estimates, recording an increase of Rs 4.08 lakh crore.

Revenue expenditure estimates were revised to Rs 30.11 lakh crore against the budget estimate of Rs 26.30 lakh crore. While there was an increase in capital expenditure estimates as well (from Rs 4.12 lakh crore in the budget estimates to Rs 4.39 lakh crore in revised estimates; at 6.55 per cent), the increase in revenue expenditure of Rs 3.71 lakh crore was much higher at 14.1 per cent.